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Cash App users can now pool money for group payments — even with non-users

Cash App [launched](#) a new peer-to-peer payment feature on Tuesday called “pools” that allows users to pool money with friends or family members to pay for expenses like grocery bills, restaurant checks, vacations, and group gifts. Initially available to select users, it will expand more widely in the coming months.

Users can create pools through the payment tab by setting a target amount and inviting contributors via their \$cashtag or texting a link to non-users to pay through Apple Pay or Google Pay.

The organizer can close the pool anytime and transfer the funds to their Cash balance.

The ability for non-users to contribute through Apple Pay and Google Pay is particularly significant, as it encourages participation from those not on the app. The platform needs growth after reporting that consumers used the app less than expected, leading to a [first-quarter gross profit](#) that fell short of its projections.

IMAGE CREDITS: CASH APP

This move comes as Cash App seeks to compete with [Venmo](#) and [PayPal](#), which both offer money-pooling capabilities.

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Lauren Forristal

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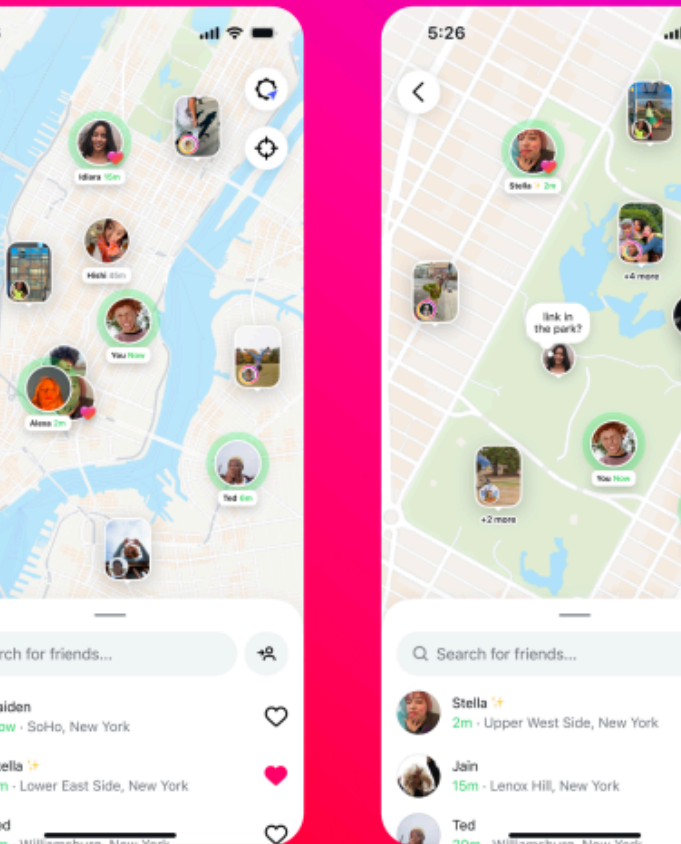


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

APPS



Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’

Aisha Malik — 7:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Instagram is rolling out Instagram Map, a new feature that lets users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content. The Meta-owned social network is also launching reposts, and making its “Friends” tab in Reels available globally.

With its new map feature, Instagram is copying yet another popular feature from Snapchat, after cloning the app’s core Stories functionality [back in 2016](#). Instagram is coming for Snap Map’s crown, a feature that recently surpassed 400 million monthly active users and remains one of the app’s core offerings.

Instagram notes that location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map, and a user’s location only updates when they open the app, meaning it doesn’t provide real-time location updates. Snap Map, on the other hand, allows users to choose

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whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

It's worth noting that Instagram does offer [real-time location sharing via DMs](#) (direct messages). However, unlike Apple's Find My and Snap Map, which let you share your location with others indefinitely, Instagram only lets users do so for up to one hour.

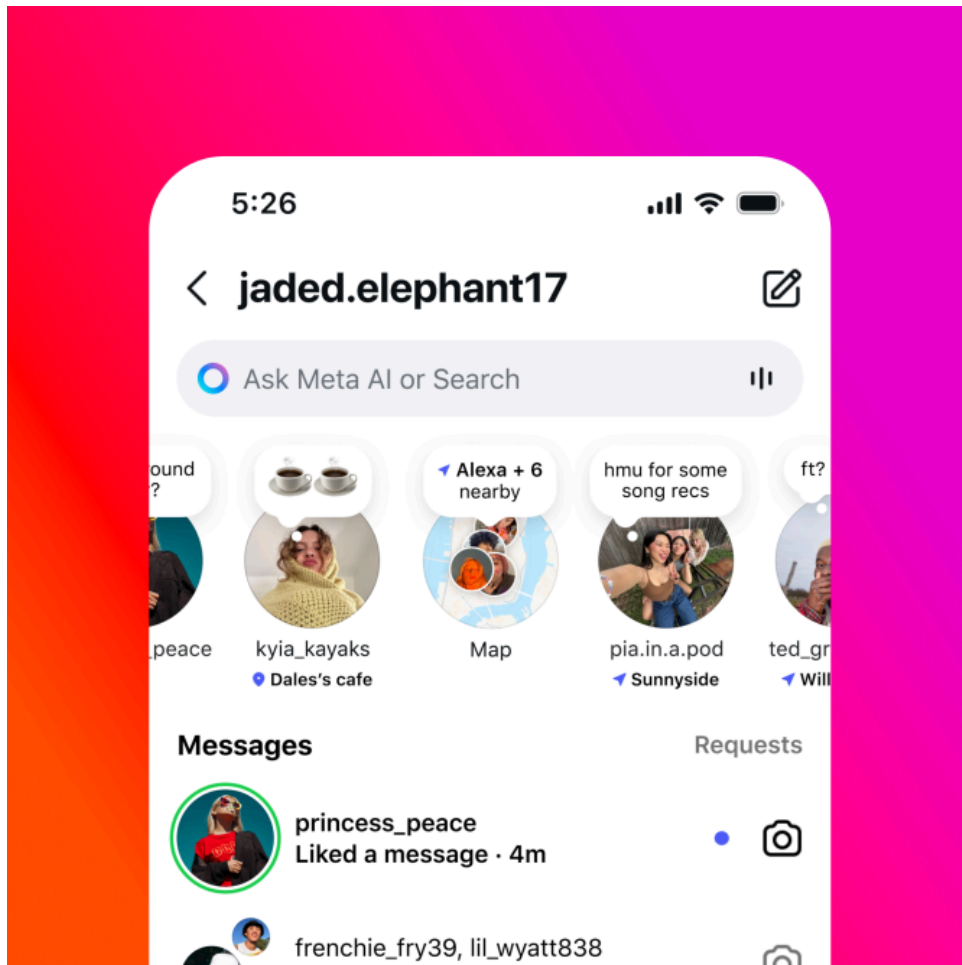


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Instagram says the new map feature will make it easier for friends to coordinate and link up for hangouts. It also lets users explore location-based content that their friends and favorite creators have shared or engaged with. For example, if your friend attends a nearby music festival and posts a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you'll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

Regardless of whether you choose to share your location, you can use the map to explore location-based content, Instagram says.

The map also allows users to leave short messages, or [“Notes,”](#) on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are currently the short messages that appear at the top of your

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direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, users can now post these short updates on the map.

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Although Instagram is certainly taking on Snapchat with this new feature, it also has the opportunity to appeal to people who were fans of [Zenly](#), a social map app that Snap acquired and then shut down in 2023.

The new map feature is launching in the United States starting Wednesday, with broader global availability coming soon. Users can find the Instagram Map at the top of their DM inbox.

The launch doesn't come as a surprise, as [Instagram was spotted developing](#) the map feature last year.



IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

As for the new “Reposts” feature, Instagram is taking a page out of [TikTok's book](#) while also creating its own version of the

popular “retweet” function from Twitter (now X).

This feature lets Instagram users repost public reels and feed posts. These reposts may show up in their friends’ feeds and will also be displayed in a new “Reposts” tab on their profile. Instagram says the new feature gives users a way to share their interests with others and also offers creators the opportunity to reach a wider audience.

To repost a reel or post, users tap the repost icon. Users can also choose to add a note to the repost by typing into the thought bubble that appears on screen and pressing save.

Regarding the new “Friends” tab in Reels, Instagram launched it in the United States earlier this year and is now making it available globally. The tab lets you see public reels that your friends have liked, commented on, reposted, and created.

For users who want to browse and interact with content privately, Instagram is rolling out the ability to opt out of having content you’ve engaged with shown in the friends tab.

Users can hide their likes, comments, and reposts from the tab. Additionally, they can choose to mute likes, comments, and reposts from specific people they follow.

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#) [🦋](#) [in](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter at MobileSyrup. Aisha...

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OpenAI’s GPT-5 is here

Maxwell Zeff — 10:00 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

OpenAI has launched GPT-5, a new flagship AI model that will power the company’s next generation of ChatGPT.

GPT-5, which was released Thursday, is OpenAI’s first “unified” AI model and combines the reasoning abilities of its [o-series](#) of models with the fast responses of its [GPT series](#). The next-generation model signals a new era for ChatGPT — and its creator, OpenAI — pointing to OpenAI’s broader ambitions to develop AI systems that are [more like agents](#) than chatbots.

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While [GPT-4](#) enabled AI chatbots to offer smart responses on a wide variety of questions, GPT-5 allows ChatGPT to complete a wide variety of tasks on behalf of users — such as generating software applications, navigating a user’s calendar, or creating research briefs.

With GPT-5, OpenAI has also sought to make ChatGPT simpler to use. Instead of asking users to choose the right settings, GPT-5 comes equipped with a real-time router that decides how to offer the best answer, whether that’s responding to user questions quickly or taking additional time to “think” through answers.

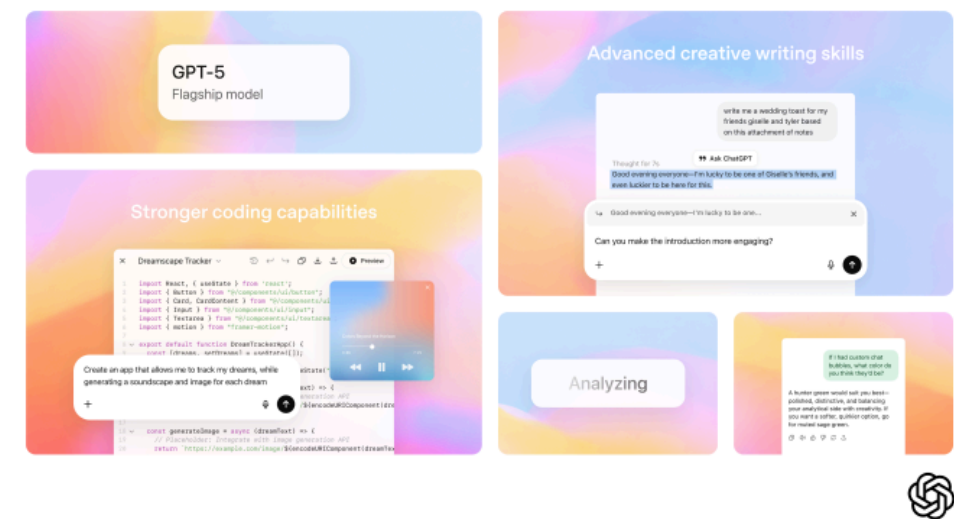


IMAGE CREDITS: OPENAI

During a briefing with reporters, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman claimed GPT-5 is “the best model in the world,” and said it represented a “significant step” along the company’s path to developing AI that can outperform humans at most economically valuable work — that is, artificial general intelligence (AGI).

“Having something like GPT-5 would be pretty much unimaginable at any previous time in history,” said Altman.

Starting Thursday, GPT-5 will be available to all free users of ChatGPT as their default model. OpenAI’s VP of ChatGPT, Nick Turley, said this is part of the company’s effort to give free users access to an AI reasoning model for the first time. (Previously, the company gated these more advanced models behind a paywall.)

“This is just one of the ways that I’m excited to live the mission, making sure that this stuff actually benefits people,” said Turley on the decision, referencing OpenAI’s long-

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standing [mission](#) to distribute advanced AI to as many people as possible.

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The expectations are high for GPT-5, one of OpenAI's most anticipated product launches since ChatGPT put the company on the map in 2022. Since then, ChatGPT has grown into one of the world's most popular consumer products, reaching more than 700 million users every week — nearly 10% of the globe's population, according to the company.

Many see GPT-5 as a bellwether for AI progress broadly, and the model's reception by Silicon Valley could have profound implications for Big Tech, Wall Street, and policymakers regulating technology. These stakeholders are watching to see if GPT-5 offers a significant jump in AI's capabilities, much like its predecessor, GPT-4, which challenged expectations of what software can do.

GPT-5 offers a slight edge on the competition

OpenAI claims GPT-5 is state-of-the-art in several domains, slightly edging out leading AI models from Anthropic, Google DeepMind, and Elon Musk's xAI on key benchmarks. However, GPT-5 slightly underperforms frontier AI models in other areas.

The company says GPT-5 offers frontier-level performance around coding; Altman said the model specifically excels at

spinning up entire software applications on demand, in what’s become known as “vibe coding.”

On SWE-bench Verified — a test of real-world coding tasks pulled from GitHub — GPT-5 scores 74.9% on its first attempt. That means GPT-5 just outperforms Anthropic’s latest Claude Opus 4.1 model, which scored [74.5%](#), and Google DeepMind’s Gemini 2.5 Pro, which scored [59.6%](#).

On Humanity’s Last Exam — a difficult test measuring AI model performance across math, humanities, and the natural sciences — a version of GPT-5 with extended reasoning (GPT-5 Pro) scored 42% when using tools. That’s slightly less than xAI was able to achieve with [Grok 4 Heavy](#), which scored 44.4% on the test.

Humanity’s Last Exam (Full Set)*
Expert-level questions across subjects

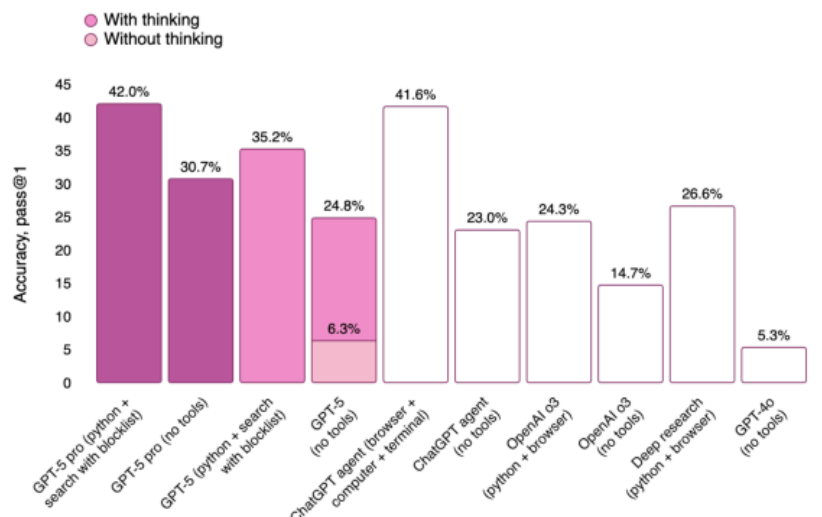


IMAGE CREDITS: OPENAI

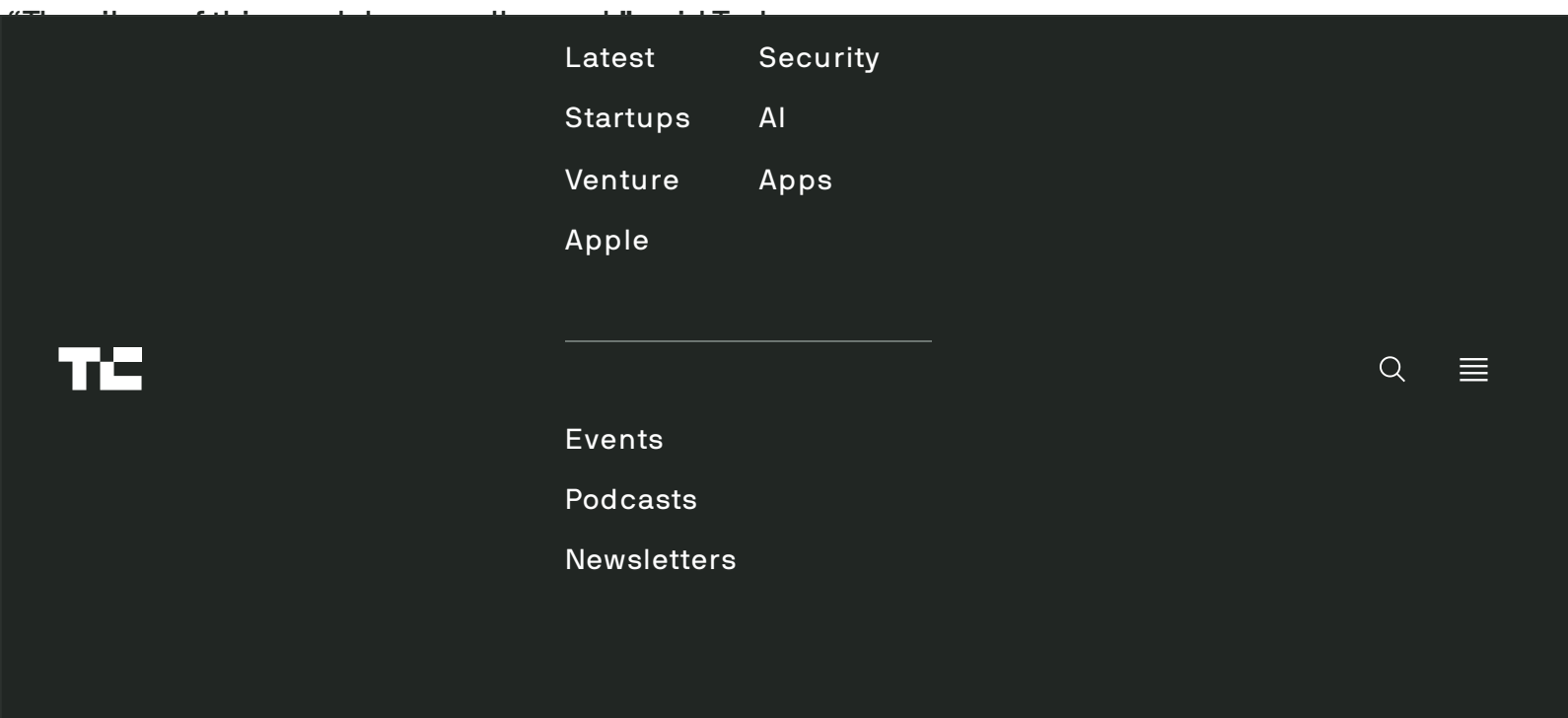
On GPQA Diamond — a test of PhD-level science questions — GPT-5 pro scored 89.4% on its first try, outperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 80.9%, and Grok 4 Heavy, which scored 88.9%.

OpenAI says GPT-5 is better for answering health-related questions. On a test measuring accuracy in AI model responses around healthcare topics, HealthBench Hard Hallucinations, OpenAI says GPT-5 (with thinking) hallucinates just 1.6% of the time. This is far lower than the company’s previous GPT-4o and o3 models, which scored 12.9% and 15.8, respectively.

While AI chatbots are not medical professionals, [millions of people](#) are using them for health advice. In response to this phenomenon, the company says GPT-5 is more proactive

about flagging potential health concerns and helping users parse medical results.

In addition, OpenAI says GPT-5 is better than other AI models on more difficult-to-measure, [subjective domains](#), such as creative design and writing. Turley said GPT-5 responds more naturally and exhibits “better taste” than other AI models on creative tasks.



On a benchmark measuring an AI model’s agentic ability to complete simulated online tasks, Tau-bench, GPT-5 offers mixed performance. On part of the test measuring an AI’s ability to navigate an airline’s website, GPT-5 scores 63.5%, slightly underperforming o3, which scored 64.8%. On another part of the test measuring AI’s ability to navigate retail websites, GPT-5 scores 81.1%, underperforming Claude Opus 4.1, which scored 82.4%.

OpenAI also says that GPT-5 is safer than its previous models. While AI reasoning models occasionally exhibit a tendency to [scheme against humans](#) or lie to promote their own goals, OpenAI found that GPT-5 was deceptive at a lower rate than other models.

Alex Beutel, OpenAI’s safety research lead, said reducing deception improves not only the safety of GPT-5, but also the user experience, creating a model that’s more “transparent and honest in ways users can trust.”

Beutel also notes GPT-5 is better at discerning between bad actors who are trying to misuse ChatGPT and users making

harmless requests. This results in GPT-5 being able to refuse more unsafe questions, while offering fewer rejections to users seeking harmless information.

Upgrades for consumers and developers

ChatGPT is getting a few user experience upgrades as part of the GPT-5 launch. Users can now select from four new personalities in ChatGPT’s setting: Cynic, Robot, Listener, and Nerd. The company says these will adapt ChatGPT’s responses without requiring users to specifically ask the model to respond in a certain way.

Subscribers to ChatGPT’s \$20-per-month Plus plan get higher usage limits for GPT-5 than free users. Meanwhile, \$200-per-month Pro subscribers will have unlimited access to GPT-5, as well as a souped-up version called GPT-5 Pro that uses additional computational resources to produce better answers. Organizations on OpenAI’s Team, Edu, and Enterprise plans will gain access to GPT-5 as their default model next week.

For developers, GPT-5 is coming to OpenAI’s API in three sizes — gpt-5, gpt-5-mini, and gpt-5-nano — which will spend more or less time “reasoning” through tasks. Developers can also now control verbosity in the OpenAI API, deciding how long or short an AI model’s responses should be.

The base model of GPT-5 will cost developers \$1.25 per million input tokens (roughly 750,000 words, longer than the entire “Lord of the Rings” series) and \$10 per million output tokens.

The launch of GPT-5 comes after a busy week for OpenAI. The company released an open-weight reasoning model, [gpt-oss](#), that developers and enterprises can download for free and run at a fraction of the cost. The open model nearly matched the abilities of OpenAI’s previous top models, o3 and o4-mini, but GPT-5 sets a new standard for frontier performance in some areas, such as coding.

However, GPT-5 seems to be roughly on par with other frontier AI models in several areas. Benchmarks, of course, only tell part of the story for any AI model, and it remains to be seen how developers will use GPT-5 in the real world, and whether the model is truly a step above the competition.



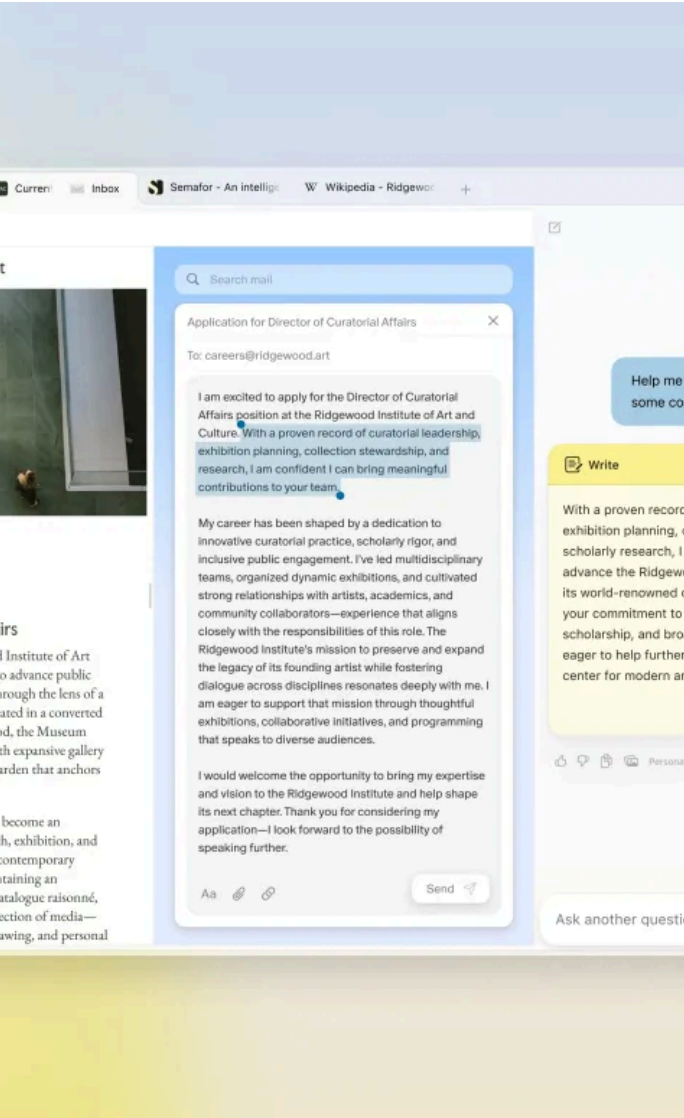
Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter |

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg, and MSNBC, Zeff has covered th...

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The Browser Company launches a \$20 monthly subscription for its AI-powered browser

Ivan Mehta — 11:26 PM PDT · August 6, 2025

The [Browser Company](#) has launched a Pro subscription plan for Dia, its new web browser that heavily integrates AI features. The plan costs \$20 per month and provides unlimited access to Dia’s AI-powered chat and skills features.

The introduction of a paid tier means free users will now face usage limits on AI features. While The Browser Company hasn’t specified exact limits, CEO Josh Miller told [The New York Times](#) in July that the browser will remain free for those who use AI features “a few times a week.”

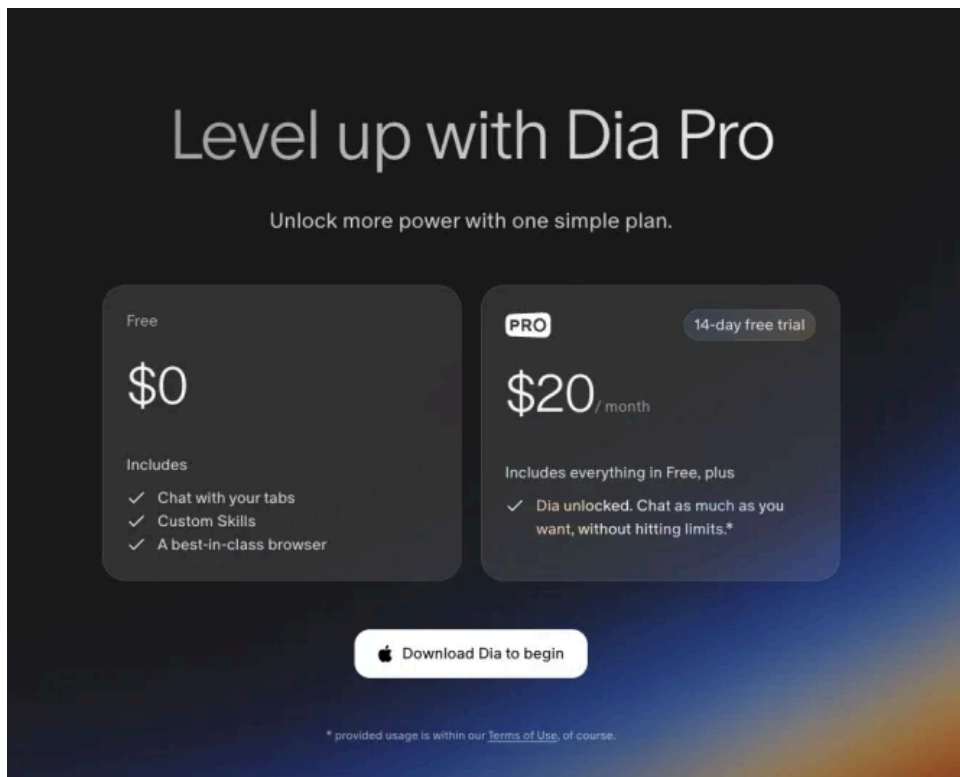


IMAGE CREDITS:SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

Miller also indicated that the startup plans to offer multiple subscription tiers, ranging from \$5 per month to hundreds of dollars monthly. The current \$20 plan appears to be one of several options based on different feature sets.

Earlier this week, users on [Reddit](#) and [Threads](#) noticed that The Browser Company had quietly made the Pro plan available online. However, the company quickly removed the page. Now the subscription option has been restored and can be accessed through Dia’s settings page.

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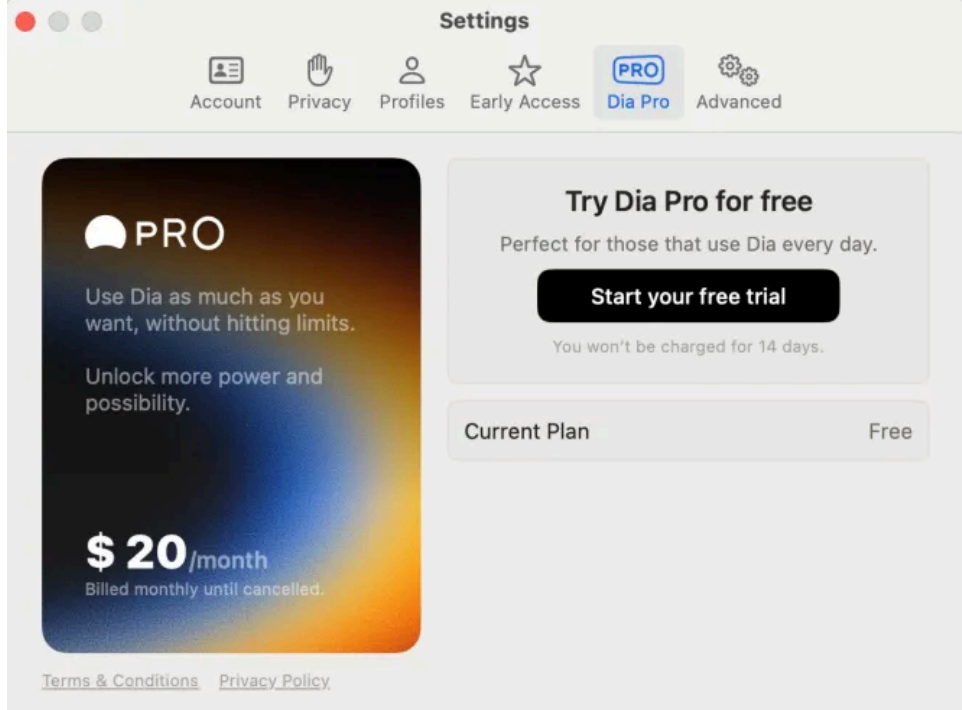


IMAGE CREDITS: SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

The Browser Company, which previously made [the Arc browser](#), has raised [\\$128 million](#) from investors, including Pace Capital, Next Play Ventures, and notable tech execs like LinkedIn's Jeff Weiner, Medium's Ev Williams, Figma's Dylan Field, Notion's Akshay Kothari, and GitHub's Jason Warner. This Pro plan represents the company's first revenue-generating subscription service.

The startup faces growing competition when it comes to AI-enhanced browsers. Perplexity's [Comet browser](#) is gaining steam, Opera is also prepping its [Neon browser](#), and incumbents like [Google](#) and [Microsoft](#) are also integrating their AI assistants into their browsers.



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Ivan Mehta



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